few others with a smile or a nod. As he passed behind me, he patted my shoulder and said something to the effect that he was impressed by what I had said and he would keep my points in view as they moved on.

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Media Interaction

The next couple of days in Washington were a blur. I was flitting from meeting to meeting during the day. During much of the night, I was on the phone with senior management back at the RBI headquarters in Mumbai—they were apprising me of the situation and seeking my approval for some 'firefighting' actions, and I was telling them about the sense I was getting from these international meetings on the growing crisis and seeking their clarifications on the inputs from my meetings and interactions in Washington.

The Fund–Bank meetings traditionally attract media from all around the world, including newspapers, magazines, wire services, network and cable TV and radio. This time round, for obvious reasons, the media were around in significantly larger numbers. Several of them, both from the international media as well as the contingent that travelled from India, were chasing me. By now, I was acutely conscious that there was growing criticism in the media back home that the new governor was not communicating enough. Over the past couples of weeks, we had taken a host of measures to restore stability in the financial markets, including pumping in liquidity, which implied reversing the tightening monetary stance that I had inherited from governor Reddy. The media view was that if the situation was so urgent and grave as to warrant such a slew of forceful measures, including a regime change in monetary policy, that too outside of the regular policy schedule, then some communication from the governor beyond just the written statement was warranted.

It was clear to me that I had to speak soon, but I was not certain whether I should do so from Washington or wait until I returned home. After